Digital Presentation

The big idea

A **presentation** is a set of **slides** used to share ideas with an audience, using text, images, charts, sound and video. **LibreOffice Impress** is a free presentation program; its files have the extension **.odp** (OpenDocument Presentation). Good presentations are short, visual and easy to read.

Starting Impress

Open **Applications > Office > LibreOffice Impress**. Choose a template from **Select a Template** or close it to start with a blank presentation. The window shows:

- **Slide pane** (thumbnails of slides) on the left,
- **Workspace** in the middle (the current slide),
- **Sidebar** on the right (Properties, Slide Transition, Animation, Master Slides…),
- Menus, toolbars and status bar.

Working with slides

- **New slide**: **Slide > New Slide** (Ctrl+M), or right-click in the Slide pane → New Slide.
- **Duplicate**: **Slide > Duplicate Slide**.
- **Delete**: select → **Slide > Delete Slide** or the Delete key.
- **Rename**: right-click → **Rename Slide**.
- **Move**: drag the slide in the Slide pane or in Slide Sorter view.

Slide layouts

A **layout** is the arrangement of placeholders (title, content, pictures) on a slide. Choose it from **Slide > Layout** or the **Layouts** panel in the **Properties** sidebar. Common layouts: **Blank Slide**, **Title Slide**, **Title, Content**, **Title and 2 Content**, **Title Only**, **Centred Text**.

Views

View	Use
Normal	Main view to create and edit slides
Outline	Shows titles and bullet points of all slides as text
Notes	Add speaker notes below each slide
Slide Sorter	Thumbnails of all slides; rearrange, delete, apply transitions
Handout	Arrange several slides per page for printing

Change views using the **View** menu.

Adding content

- Click a placeholder to type; use the Formatting toolbar for font, size, colour and bullets.
- **Insert > Image** for pictures; **Insert > Chart**; **Insert > Table**; **Insert > Audio or Video**; **Insert > Text Box** (F2).
- **Master slide** (View > Master Slide) sets common design (logo, font, background) for all slides. **Slide > Slide Properties** changes background or page size.

Transitions and animations

- **Transition**: effect *between* slides. Select slides → **Slide > Slide Transition** (or the Slide Transition sidebar panel) → choose effect (Wipe, Fade, Push…), variant, duration and sound; *Advance slide*: On mouse click or Automatically after N seconds; **Apply Transition to All Slides** if needed.
- **Animation**: effect on an *object* within a slide. Select the object → **Format > Animation** (or the Animation sidebar) → **+ Add** → choose Entrance, Emphasis, Exit or Motion Path effect, and its start (On click, With previous, After previous).

TRANSITION VS ANIMATION

Transition applies to the whole slide as it changes to the next. **Animation** applies to text or objects inside a slide.

Running the slide show

- **F5**: start from the first slide (**Slide Show > Start from First Slide**).
- **Shift+F5**: start from the current slide.
- Move with **Enter, Spacebar, arrow keys, Page Down** or mouse click; **Esc** ends the show.
- **Slide Show > Slide Show Settings** sets range, loop, pointer options.

Tips for an effective presentation

- One main idea per slide; about **6 bullet points with 6 words each** (the 6×6 rule).
- Large, readable fonts (at least 24 pt for text); good contrast.
- Use images and charts instead of long paragraphs.
- Keep transitions and animations simple and consistent.

A 5-SLIDE PROJECT ON "SAVE WATER"

1. Title Slide – title and your name. 2. Why water is precious – 3 bullets and a picture. 3. Causes of water waste – Title, Content. 4. How we can save water – Title and 2 Content (text + image). 5. Thank you – Centred Text. Apply a Fade transition to all and start with F5.

SHORTCUT MARKS

Ctrl+M new slide, F5 start show, Shift+F5 from current slide, Esc end show.

Quick recap

- Impress files: .odp; a presentation is a set of slides.
- Layouts arrange placeholders; views: Normal, Outline, Notes, Slide Sorter, Handout.
- Transition = between slides; animation = objects within a slide.
- F5 start, Shift+F5 current slide, Esc exit; keep slides simple.

Practice questions

1. The extension of a LibreOffice Impress file is
   (a) .odt (b) .ods (c) .odp (d) .odg
2. Which key starts a slide show from the first slide?
   (a) F5 (b) F7 (c) F11 (d) F2
3. Which view shows thumbnails of all slides for rearranging them?
   (a) Notes view (b) Outline view (c) Normal view (d) Slide Sorter view
4. The effect when one slide changes to the next is called a
   (a) layout (b) animation (c) transition (d) master slide
5. The shortcut to insert a new slide in Impress is
   (a) Ctrl+N (b) Ctrl+M (c) Ctrl+S (d) Ctrl+T
6. To make a logo appear on every slide, you should edit the
   (a) Notes view (b) Slide Sorter (c) Handout (d) Master slide
7. Which key ends a running slide show?
   (a) Enter (b) Spacebar (c) Tab (d) Esc
8. Differentiate between slide transition and custom animation.
9. Name any four views in LibreOffice Impress and state the use of each.

Answers: 1. c 2. a 3. d 4. c 5. b 6. d 7. d 8. see notes 9. see notes